

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 597

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend Beverly Bell.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should honor those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have devoted themselves to improving the lives of others; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy individual is Beverly Bell of Lebanon, who is the founder and director of Optimum Hope!, a nonprofit wellness recovery program specifically designed for individuals living with Parkinson's disease; and

WHEREAS, Beverly Bell graduated from Pensacola Junior College in 1991 with an Associate of Arts degree as a physical therapy assistant; and

WHEREAS, moving to Tennessee soon thereafter, Mrs. Bell embarked on a distinguished thirty-one-year career as a physical therapist assistant, working in home health, rehabilitation, and clinical settings and specializing in the treatment and care of patients with Parkinson's disease; and

WHEREAS, upon nearing retirement, she recognized a serious gap in continued therapy options for Parkinson's patients in Wilson County; refusing to let that need go unmet, she founded Optimum Hope! in 2016 with colleague Michele Lineberry under the auspices of The Therapy Gym; and

WHEREAS, beginning her endeavor with only five members and no salary, Beverly Bell poured her time, talent, and passion into building Optimum Hope! into a thriving nonprofit organization that currently serves more than sixty-five participants; and

WHEREAS, she has taught up to six classes each Monday, Wednesday, and Friday at the Mount Juliet location, conducted additional classes at the Jimmy Floyd Center in Lebanon

and Del Webb in Mount Juliet, and met privately with clients throughout the week—all with minimal or no compensation during most of the past eight years; and

WHEREAS, Optimum Hope! has grown to include professional staff, including a personal trainer and an occupational therapist, and is supported through grants from the Parkinson's Foundation, scholarships from Peterson's Parkinson's in Nashville, and the dedication of its members; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Bell holds numerous specialized certifications, including as a PWR! (Parkinson's Wellness Recovery) Move Instructor and in Lee Silverman Voice Treatment, Rock Steady Boxing, lymphedema, and neuro-progressive therapy, demonstrating her exceptional expertise and steadfast dedication to evidence-based care; and

WHEREAS, she also supports and teaches at the Mount Juliet Parkinson's Support Group and participates annually in Moving Day Nashville, the statewide Parkinson's Foundation event that raises awareness and celebrates the power of movement in managing the disease; and

WHEREAS, through Optimum Hope! and her tireless volunteerism, Beverly Bell has inspired countless Tennesseans affected by Parkinson's disease to persevere, rebuild confidence, and celebrate every victory, large or small; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to pause in our deliberations to acknowledge and applaud Mrs. Bell for her dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Beverly Bell, Founder and Director of Optimum Hope!, for her dedicated service to Tennesseans living with Parkinson's disease and extend to her our best wishes for continued success and happiness in all her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.